

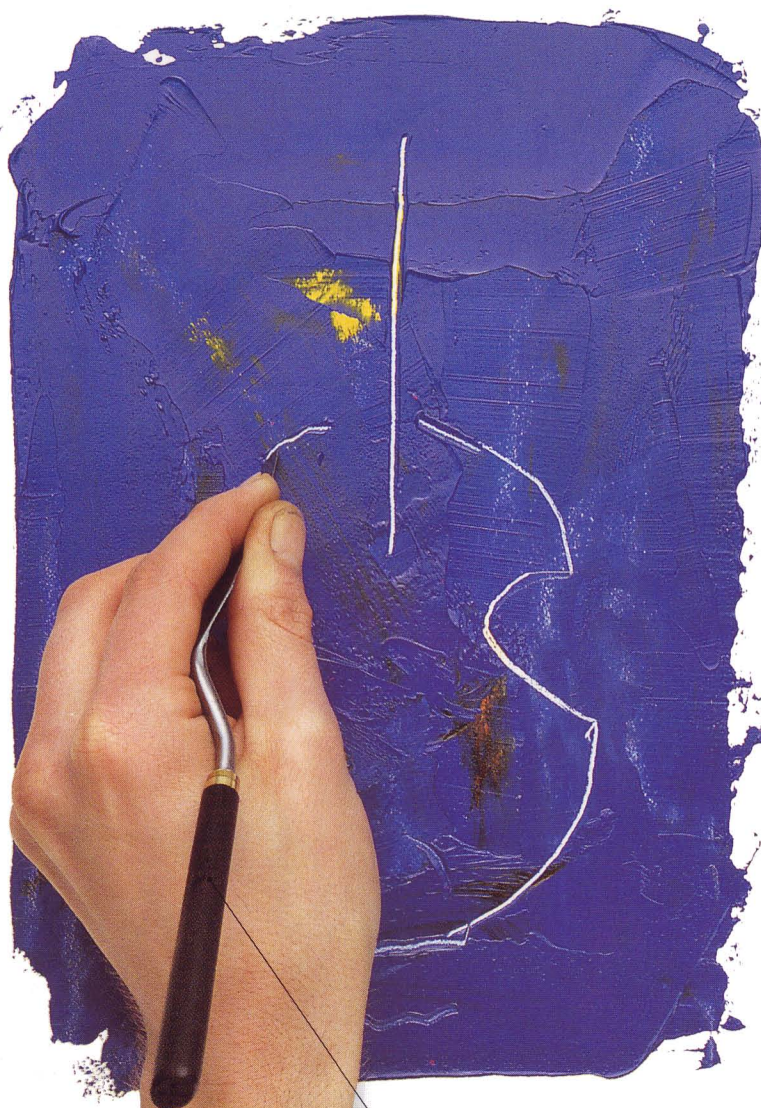
EXPERIMENTAL TECHNIQUES

ARTISTS HAVE ALWAYS EXPERIMENTED with different ways of working with oil paint. One traditional technique is sgraffito, in which one color is laid over another layer of dry color and then scratched through with a sharp instrument so that the color beneath is revealed as an image or pattern. Another technique is to paint or splash thick colors onto a canvas or board, lay a sheet of thin, hard paper or plastic over the top, lift some of the

paint off, and use the remaining image for special textural or surreal effects. Nowadays, there are also new materials developed by manufacturers. A relatively recent product is the oil stick, which is basically oil paint in stick form. This allows you to draw with the oil paint as though it were a pastel or a piece of charcoal. It has a smooth, creamy feel and it is possible to work it into a wet color and still retain the color of the stroke you are making.

Sgraffito

Sgraffito is an old method of drawing into a layer of wet paint to produce a line drawing of an image or a detail. When you scratch through the layer of wet paint you should reveal a new color underneath, whether it is another layer of dried paint, or the canvas or board itself. Here, a thick layer of blue paint has been applied with a painting knife, and the blade of the knife then used as the drawing instrument. You can use all kinds of tools for this technique; a screwdriver, for instance, will give a line similar to that made by drawing with a carpenter's pencil. Many artists whittle the end of an old paintbrush for sgraffito effects as the softer wood is less likely to damage the canvas.



Hold the blade of a painting knife as firmly as possible and drag it through a layer of wet paint.

